



Rating
Hold

North America
United States

TMT
Software

Company
Workday

Reuters
WDAY.OQ

Bloomberg
WDAY US

Date
28 August 2026

Rating	Hold
Price target (USD)	220.00
Price at 27 Aug 26	193.57
52-week range	247.69 – 112.50

[Valuation & Risks](#)

Helpful preliminary FY28 outlook, still early days on AI

Workday reported a mostly solid quarter, ahead on both the top and bottom line and with 12-month subscription backlog performance modestly above the midpoint of guidance. Regardless, investor focus is likely more on the preliminary FY28 outlook where management opened with +11% subscription revenue growth outlook, consistent with the expected rate in 2H27. This likely helps alleviate some concerns around further deceleration, even if it possibly includes some very modest M&A contribution. Initial expectations for non-GAAP margin expansion were better than consensus, which could help out-year free cash flow estimates. We also note the company was asked about headlines on a possible take private, to which CEO Aneel Bhusri noted he was unable to comment, which to us suggests a possibility that talks could remain active (see our preview [here](#) for thoughts on the take private).

The initial FY28 outlook likely helps to balance FY27 revenue guidance that was raised at the midpoint by less than 1H outperformance and 12-month backlog guidance that was lower than we had expected ahead of the event. We note, however, Workday likely embedded some additional prudence in the 2H guide as it navigates the transition towards hybrid subscription/consumption contracts. On the positive side, non-GAAP operating margin guidance for the year was raised another 50bps, which we believe continues to reflect ongoing spend discipline. With 2H facing easier compares vs 1H on OpEx growth, we think there could likely be more upside from here.

AI metrics highlighted were encouraging. AI new ACV >\$100mn and represented >25% of new ACV added in the quarter, and total AI ACV was up 20% q/q to \$600mn. More than 5,500 are using one or more organic agents, while 200 customers signed for additional flex credits even as the company runs promotions to drive adoption and usage of agents. These points signal to us that it remains early days for Workday's AI ambitions, and we look forward to learning more about new innovations and work to accelerate adoption at Rising. Workday Go customer volume 5x'd from 1Q, which combined with the recently released deployment and adoption agents has us more optimistic on the down-market opportunity from here.

Putting it all together, F2Q was mostly solid and we believe the preliminary FY28 outlook helps offset modestly disappointing 3Q 12-month subscription backlog and FY27 subscription growth guides. Given the shares traded up on possible deal headlines earlier this month, we do not expect results or guidance today will

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meaningfully impact the shares, despite likely higher FCF estimates in the out-years from better margin expansion. Maintain our Hold-rating and DCF-driven \$220 target price.

Figure 1: 2Q Results

Workday (WDAY)				
In \$mn except EPS				
	2Q27			
	Actual	DBe	Cons.	Guidance
Income Statement				
Subscription Revenue	2,471	2,455	2,455	2,455
Y/Y Growth	+13.9%	+13.2%	+13.2%	
Q/Q Growth	+5.0%	+4.3%	+4.3%	
Professional Svcs Revenue	178	180	180	180
Y/Y Growth	-0.6%	+0.5%	+0.8%	
Q/Q Growth	-5.3%	-4.3%	-4.1%	
Total Revenue	2,649	2,635	2,635	2,635
Y/Y Growth	+12.8%	+12.2%	+12.2%	
Q/Q Growth	+4.2%	+3.7%	+3.7%	
Non-GAAP Gross Profit	2,094	2,094	2,087	
Non-GAAP GM (%)	79.0%	79.5%	79.2%	
Y/Y Growth	+13.4%	+13.4%	+13.0%	
Non-GAAP OI	824	791	790	
Non-GAAP OM (%)	31.1%	30.0%	30.0%	30.0%
Y/Y Growth	+21.2%	16.3%	+16.2%	
Non-GAAP EPS	\$2.75	\$2.57	\$2.61	
Operating Metrics				
Operating Cash Flow	520	692	682	
Y/Y Growth	-15.6%	12.4%	+10.7%	
Free Cash Flow	460	631	616	
Y/Y Growth	-21.8%	7.4%	+4.8%	
12-month Subscription Backlog	9,034	9,013	9,017	
Y/Y Growth	+14.2%	+13.9%	+14.0%	13.5-14.5%

Source: Deutsche Bank Research, Company Data, Bloomberg Finance LP



Figure 2: Estimate Changes

Workday (WDAY)											
In \$mn except EPS											
	3Q27E				FY27E				FY28E		
	DB estimates	Old estimates	Cons.	Company guidance	DB estimates	Old estimates	Cons.	Company guidance	DB estimates	Old estimates	Cons.
Income Statement											
Subscription Revenue	2,515	2,526	2,517	2,515	9,946	9,944	9,942	9,940-9,950	11,040	11,085	11,143
Y/Y Growth	+12.1%	+12.6%	+12.2%		+12.6%	+12.6%	+12.6%	+13%	+11.0%	+11.5%	+12.1%
Q/Q Growth	+1.8%	+2.9%	+1.9%								
Professional Svcs Revenue	175	179	180	175	710	710	714	710	714	713	716
Y/Y Growth	-7.0%	-5.0%	-4.3%		-1.4%	-1.4%	-0.8%		+0.5%	+0.5%	+0.3%
Q/Q Growth	-1.8%	-0.7%	+1.1%								
Total Revenue	2,690	2,705	2,699	2,690	10,657	10,654	10,669	10,650-10,660	11,754	11,798	11,842
Y/Y Growth	+10.6%	+11.2%	+11.0%		+11.6%	+11.5%	+11.7%	+12%	+10.3%	+10.7%	+11.0%
Q/Q Growth	+1.5%	+2.7%	+1.9%								
Non-GAAP Gross Profit	2,131	2,139	2,140		8,467	8,477	8,461		9,365	9,400	9,418
Non-GAAP GM (%)	79.2%	79.1%	79.3%		79.5%	79.6%	79.3%		79.7%	79.7%	79.5%
Y/Y Growth	+10.8%	+11.3%	+11.3%		+11.8%	+11.9%	+11.7%		+10.6%	+10.9%	+11.3%
Non-GAAP OI	807	784	797		3,306	3,254	3,261		3,877	3,793	3,749
Non-GAAP OM (%)	30.0%	29.0%	29.5%	30.0%	31.0%	30.5%	30.6%	31.0%	33.0%	32.1%	31.7%
Y/Y Growth	+16.6%	13.3%	+15.2%		+17.1%	15.3%	+15.5%		+17.3%	16.6%	+15.0%
Non-GAAP EPS	\$2.70	\$2.58	\$2.65		\$11.02	\$10.71	\$10.77		\$13.37	\$12.81	\$12.63
Operating Metrics											
Operating Cash Flow	823	653	693		3,450	3,450	3,450	3,450	4,169	3,995	3,971
Y/Y Growth	+39.9%	11.0%	+17.8%		+17.4%	17.4%	+17.4%		+20.8%	15.8%	+15.1%
Free Cash Flow	758	590	624		3,180	3,181	3,180	3,180	3,890	3,715	3,671
Y/Y Growth	+37.9%	7.3%	+13.5%		+14.5%	14.5%	+14.5%		+22.3%	16.8%	+15.4%
12-month Subscription Backlog	9,153	9,211	9,314		9,805	9,893	10,023		10,834	11,031	11,184
Y/Y Growth	+11.5%	+12.2%	+13.5%	11-12%	+11.0%	+12.0%	+13.5%		+10.5%	+11.5%	+14.1%

Source: Deutsche Bank Research, Company Data, Bloomberg Finance LP

Estimate changes, Valuation and Risks

Following F2Q results, we adjust our FY27/28 revenue estimates to \$10.66bn/\$11.75bn from \$10.65bn/\$11.80bn and our free cash flow estimates to \$3.18bn/\$3.89bn from \$3.18bn/\$3.72bn to reflect our updated views on the business. Our DCF-derived target price of \$220 (unch.) assumes a terminal WACC of 10.5% and a terminal risk-free rate of 4%. We use a terminal growth rate of 2.5%, based on subsector growth. Downside risks include: (1) back-office investments deprioritized in favor of more front-office agentic investments, (2) agents so productive that headcount reductions drive downsells/churn, (3) early renewals/co-terms over the last 2-3 years inhibit upsell opportunities, and (4) greater than expected competition in either the HCM or FINS markets. Upside risks include (1) announcement of a take-private deal or strategic acquisition, (2) accelerated expansion of flex credit usage from AI features, (3) accelerated adoption of Workday products down-market, and (4) accelerated adoption of FINS from end of life of legacy ERPs.



Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

Company	Ticker	Recent price	Disclosure
Workday	WDAY.OQ	193.57 (USD) 27 Aug 26	2, 8, 14, 15, 24

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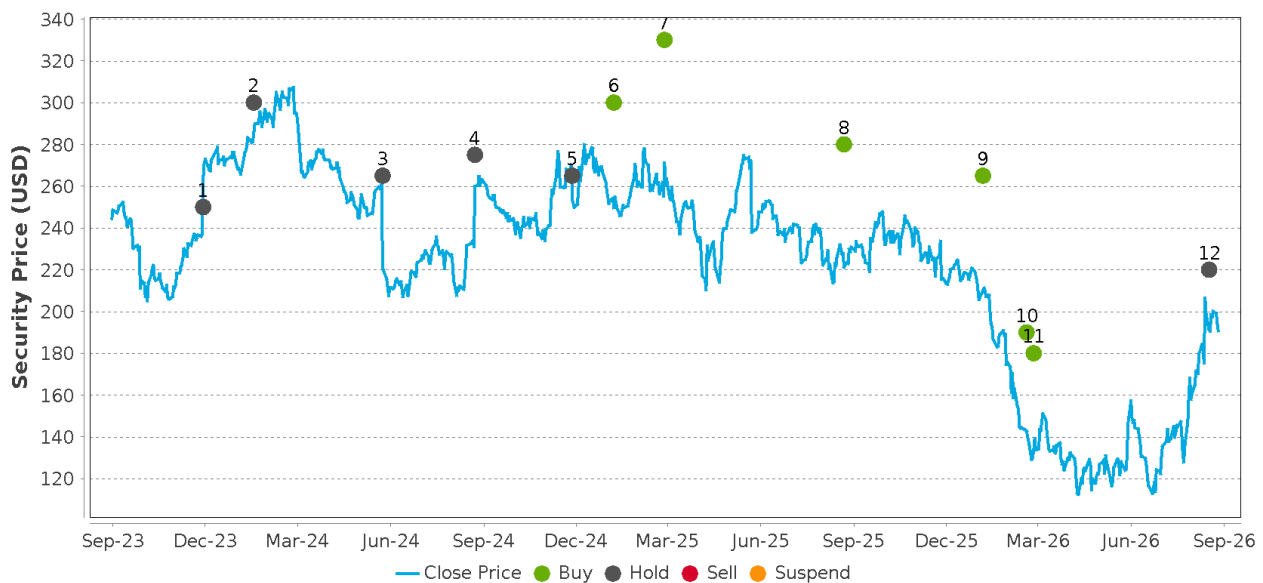
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Historical recommendations and target price: Workday (WDAY.OQ)



1.	29 Nov 23	Price target: 250 (USD), close price 263.49 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
2.	18 Jan 24	Price target: 300 (USD), close price 285.68 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
3.	24 May 24	Price target: 265 (USD), close price 220.91 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
4.	23 Aug 24	Price target: 275 (USD), close price 259.95 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
5.	27 Nov 24	Price target: 265 (USD), close price 253.4 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
6.	7 Jan 25	Price target: 300 (USD), close price 249.68 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
7.	26 Feb 25	Price target: 330 (USD), close price 271.09 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
8.	22 Aug 25	Price target: 280 (USD), close price 221.27 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
9.	6 Jan 26	Price target: 265 (USD), close price 210.3 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
10.	18 Feb 26	Price target: 190 (USD), close price 142.63 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
11.	25 Feb 26	Price target: 180 (USD), close price 133.15 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Brad Zelnick
12.	17 Aug 26	Price target: 220 (USD), close price 191.18 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Brad Zelnick



Company rating dispersion and banking relationships

DBSI Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	57%	42%	0%
w/ Banking relationship	44%	34%	0%
w/ MiFID services	64%	51%	67%

Global Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	40%	2%
w/ Banking relationship	47%	31%	29%
w/ MiFID services	75%	68%	91%

Company Rating and Dispersion Key

The above table provides a snapshot of Deutsche Bank's company research rating distribution across our covered companies. We also present the percentage of companies where Deutsche Bank has provided Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months and/or MIFID Investment and Ancillary services, in the past 12 months. Please see the key and definition of our rating below.

Note - percentages are rounded so may not total 100%.

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Rating definitions:

Buy: Based on a current 12-month view of TSR, we recommend that investors buy the stock.

Sell: Based on a current 12-month view of TSR, we recommend that investors sell the stock.

Hold: We take a neutral view on the stock 12-months out and, based on this time horizon, do not recommend either a Buy or Sell.

TSR: Total Shareholder Return. Percentage change in share price from current price to projected target price plus projected dividend yield.

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